



Overview

ASIA PACIFIC SHELTER FORUM IN INDONESIA AUGUST 2019

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This year Asia Pacific Shelter Forum was held in Lombok Indonesia on August 2019 combined with National Shelter Conference hosted by the Ministry of Social Affairs with coordination support from IFRC. The forum brings together shelter practitioners from, and/or working in the region to share ideas and lessons learned on humanitarian shelter and settlement initiatives and programs which aims to build stronger community of shelter practice across the region.

Included in the event is a full day field visit to earthquake affected areas in Lombok to observe and discuss progress and challenges in post-disaster recovery and reconstruction in urban areas.

Attended by approximately 140 participants from the region, and 13 out of 140 participants are CRS and Caritas representative. Nine (9) CRS staff from 5 Country Programs such as Bangladesh, India, Indonesia, Nepal and Philippines; two (2) staff from Caritas Bangladesh and two (2) S&S HRD staff had participated the forum. All CRS and Caritas staff presented at different sessions bringing a lot of credit to CRS.

The forum allowed time for discussions on six (6) thematic sessions such as:

1. Flexible cash in shelter programming
2. Improving response when we have low sector capacity
3. On-going challenge of transitioning from emergency to permanent
4. Localization and nationalization of shelter response
5. Addressing house and land, security and tenure, and
6. Retrofitting bracing and physically reducing risk

QUICKFACTS

Type	Asia Pacific Shelter Forum
Location	Lombok, Indonesia
# of people in attendance	140
Date of forum	August 22-23, 2019
Host	Ministry of Social Affairs with IFRC

An “open space” was also allocated for participants to nominate topics of interest followed by vibrant discussions and debate about the selected topics.

After the event, CRS and Caritas staff had debrief and reflect; each one sharing their observations, learning experience and takeaways from the forum.

DEBRIEF AND REFLECTION FROM CRS AND CARITAS PARTICIPANTS

Thematic Learning

- Emergency to recovery connection requires further attention within the cluster system
- It is fitting that CRS are focusing on Coordination and implementation balance
- Localization and nationalization should be strengthened
- Localisation should invest more in government



Rahmat Taufik sharing CRS Indonesia experiences on localization standards and guidelines

- Different government approaches from different countries
- Caritas approach to community engagement can influence others
- Understood that HLP is complex and needs expert support, many organisations are finding challenges, learnt that IFRC has a regional HLP advisor (Lawyer).
- Reducing risk programs should start ahead before occurrence of calamities. Government funding should be mobilized for DRR programming
- Cash based programming offer flexibilities but program duration needs to be longer

Organizational Learning

- CRS and partners presence were important to show our commitment and depth of expertise and to be one of the leaders in this sector.
 - ✓ Many were surprised by CRS and partners strength, thus important to keep sharing, keep leading conversations.
 - ✓ Realisation that CRS and partners can offer technical assistance to other agencies and government.
- Participated Staff benefited by the exposure to other organisations approach, regional and global conversations.
 - ✓ For next opportunities consider a balance of new staff and experienced staff to attend and gender balance.
 - ✓ For next forum encourage more participation from Caritas MO and CISSWG.
- Regional sharing and learning can be strengthened in all levels, country to country, cluster to cluster, within agency, within CI network
- For Indonesia, MOSA vs. BNPB roles and responsibilities should be harmonized
- Roles and Responsibilities of National Cluster need to be clarified and reinforced
- Deliverables are most important and work at national level to help create a more flexible framework

Field Visit Observation and Learning

- Construction quality of shelters are compromised. Technical assistance should always be provided.
- Beneficiaries are consulted but not involved in the design and construction of their emergency and permanent shelter
- Shelter program is not a process but more on a “product”
- Simultaneous disaster would force the government to shift their prioritization without completing the previous intervention in Lombok. Country capacity should be evaluated and if needed allow international relief to come in
- Socio- technical part was properly addressed
- National cluster structures look good on paper but questionable when comparing outcomes in the field

WHAT'S NEXT?

- Year 2020 Asia Pacific Shelter Forum shall be hosted in Nepal requiring CRS and Caritas involvement
- Encourage more of our upcoming staff to attend shelter forums for exposure and learning opportunities
- Be proactive to share our own expertise and practices at local level
- Develop an email distribution list to share regular updates within the group
- Reach-out to the group if anyone needs work assistance based on CPs specialization as demonstrated by each CP

Find links to the presentations [here](#).



Ruel Bansali of CRS Philippines presenting House and Land, Security and Tenure



Seki Hirano, S&S Sr. TA presenting area -based approach in Shelter and Settlement Programming



Ariel Sadural, S&S TA presenting localization and nationalization approach in Shelter Programming



Sailendra Pattanaik sharing CRS India's experiences during one of the open space sessions entitled 'construction monitoring'



Ratan Kumar Podder, Shelter/NFI Co-coordinator sharing updates about Shelter Response in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh



Sajina Sherpa of CRS Nepal presenting the country program Localization and Nationalization experiences



Syahri Ramadhan of CRS Indonesia presenting Cash Based Approach in Shelter Programming



Abdul Mamum sharing CRS Bangladesh experienced on Flexible Cash Based Programming



Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP Deputy Chief of Party sharing updates about HRRP initiatives in Nepal



Mazharul Islam of Caritas Bangladesh presenting Localization and Nationalization response in Bangladesh



CRS and Caritas Participants (From left, John Girsang, Seki Hirano, Sailendra Pattanaik, Ruel Bansali, Abdul Mamun, Mazharul Islam, Sajina Sherpa, Ariel Sadural, Rahmat Taufik, Minar Thapar Magar, Johannes Juliasman, Ratan Kumar Podder and Syahri Ramadhan)



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